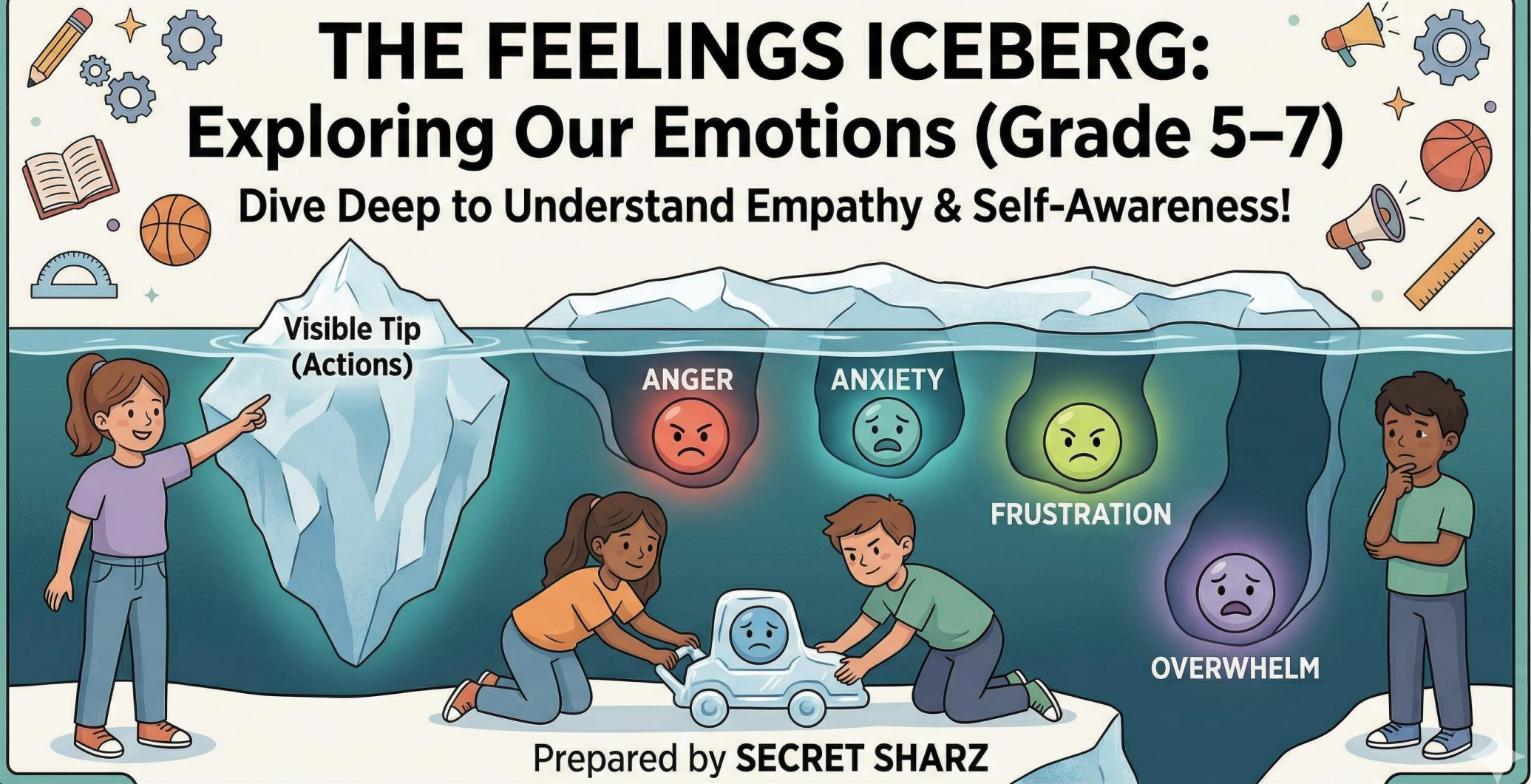


THE FEELINGS ICEBERG: Exploring Our Emotions (Grade 5–7)

Dive Deep to Understand Empathy & Self-Awareness!



Prepared by **SECRET SHARZ**

INTRODUCTION & THE CORE METAPHOR

WELCOME TO THE FEELINGS ICEBERG

This handbook is designed for life skills instructors to help students in grades 5-7 explore the depths of their emotional world. In this 35-minute session, students will learn that what we observe on the surface is only a tiny fraction of the human experience.

The Visible Tip (10%):

Represents the outward behaviors and reactions we see in others.



Above the Surface

Below the Surface (90%):

Represents the hidden emotions and feelings that actually drive those behaviors.



Fear or Insecurity



Hurt or Loneliness



Confusion or Frustration

Common Hidden Emotions



Fear



Insecurity



Hurt



Loneliness



Confusion



Frustration

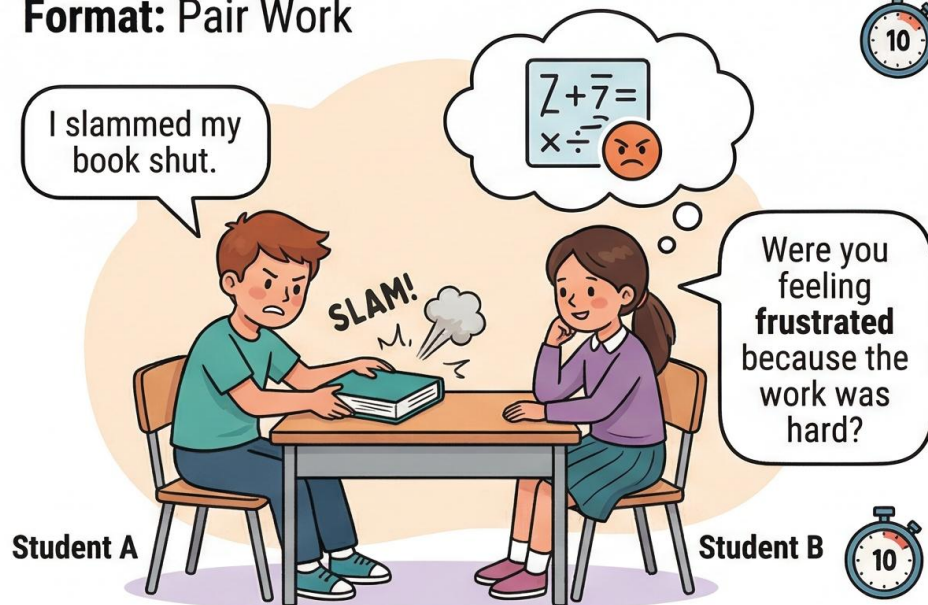


INTERACTIVE ACTIVITIES



ACTIVITY 1: GUESSING HIDDEN FEELINGS (10 Mins)

Format: Pair Work



Student A

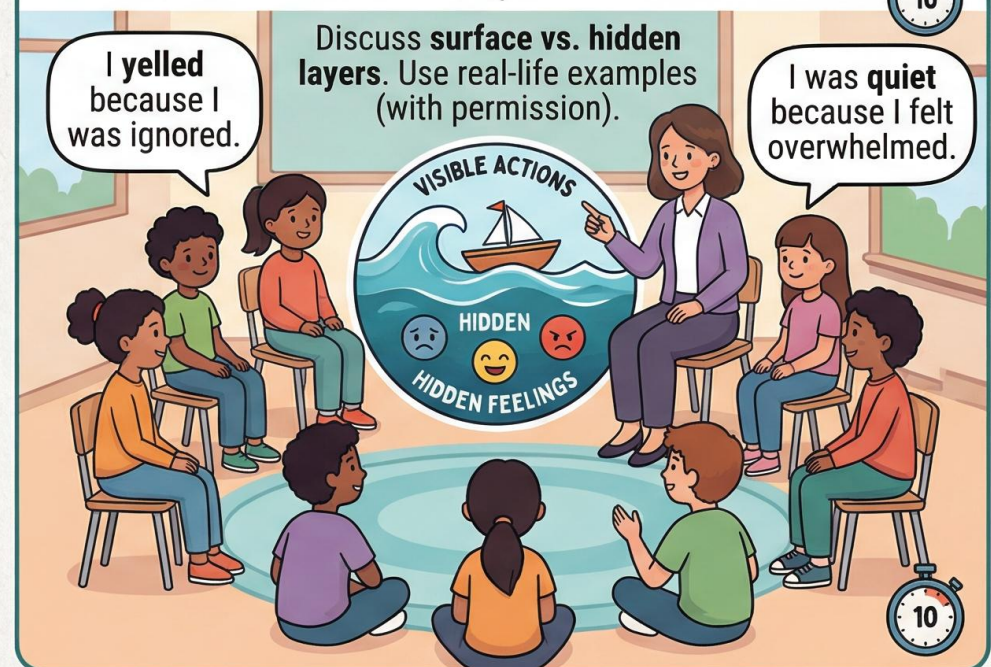
Student B

Goal: Practice active listening and empathy.



ACTIVITY 2: CLASSROOM DISCUSSION (10 Mins)

Format: Facilitated Group Talk



KEY MESSAGE: IT IS OKAY to have a wide range of emotions; understanding them builds healthy relationships.



FULL CLASS DEBRIEF

Has someone ever responded **ONLY** to your surface anger or silence, completely missing what was really going on?

Scenario A: Reacting to the Surface



DEEP FEELINGS
MISSED



Scenario B: Looking Underneath



LOOKING
BENEATH THE
WATERLINE



Knowing about icebergs helps us not take anger personally and instead ask what is really happening underneath.

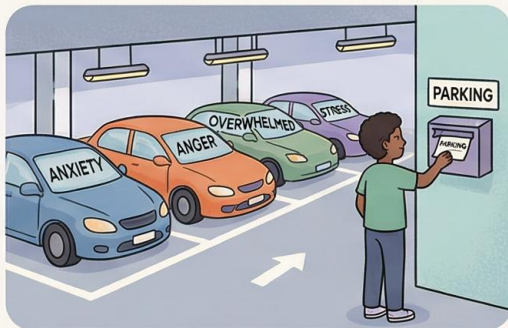
Prepared by **SECRET SHARZ**

INSTRUCTIONAL STRATEGIES & SAFETY

CREATING A SAFE SPACE

To explore deep emotions, students must feel secure.

The “Parking Lot”



The “Parking Lot”

Designate a physical or metaphorical space where students can “park” overwhelming emotions to address at a better time.

Expression Tools



Expression Tools

Encourage students to process feelings through journaling, art, or quiet contemplation.

UNDERSTANDING VISIBLE REACTIONS

Help students decode common classroom behaviors:



QUIET/WITHDRAWN

May indicate feeling overwhelmed or sad.



SHOUTING/DISRUPTIVE

Often signals a student feels frustrated or unheard.



SLAMMING DOORS

Frequently a sign of feeling angry or deeply hurt.

UNDERSTANDING VISIBLE REACTIONS

QUIET/WITHDRAWN



**MAY INDICATE FEELING
OVERWHELMED
OR SAD.**

SHOUTING/DISRUPTIVE



**OFTEN SIGNALS
FEELING FRUSTRATED
OR UNHEARD.**

SLAMMING DOORS



**FREQUENTLY A SIGN
OF FEELING ANGRY
OR DEEPLY HURT.**

**A GUIDE TO DECODING BEHAVIOR AND
FOSTERING EMPATHY IN THE CLASSROOM.**

Prepared by **SECRET SHARZ**